Comment-to-DM

Set up ManyChat so anyone who comments your keyword gets your link by DM in seconds, while you keep every real conversation personal.

BUILDER | 45 MIN | PLAYBOOK: AUTOMATION STARTER PACK | PLAYBOOK: HOOK & CAPTION BANK

WHEN THIS HAPPENS	THIS HAPPENS
Someone comments your keyword on a Reel or post	They get a public reply and a DM with your link in seconds, and the lead goes in your Pipeline Tracker

TOOLS	COST	SETUP	CHECKED
ManyChat, Instagram	Free plan available, with a small monthly contact limit. Check current pricing.	about 30 min	2026-10

YOU WALK AWAY WITH

One live comment-to-DM automation on Instagram, tested from a friend's account, with every new lead logged in your Pipeline Tracker.

USE IT

Use it once you post three or more times a week and people keep asking for the same link, price or guide in your comments.

People comment. You send the link by hand, hours later. By then, many have moved on.

This recipe turns "Comment PRICE" into a DM that arrives in seconds. The automation sends the link. You handle every real question yourself.

What this does

Someone comments your keyword, like CLEAN or GUIDE. ManyChat replies to the comment in public and sends a DM with one button. When they tap it, the link arrives. Anything else comes to you.

> Why a button first: Instagram lets a business send one automated message to someone who commented, until they respond. Tapping the button counts as their response. That opens a 24-hour window, so ManyChat can send the link next.

Before you start

- [ ] Your Instagram is a professional account (Business or Creator). ManyChat needs this.
- [ ] A free ManyChat account connected to that Instagram account.
- [ ] One free thing worth commenting for: a price list, a checklist, a sample or a booking link.
- [ ] The link works on a phone. If it's a Google Doc, set sharing to anyone with the link.
- [ ] Your Pipeline Tracker is open, ready to log leads.
- [ ] A friend with an Instagram account is ready to test it.

Pick your keyword

One word. Easy to spell. Tied to what they get. Put it in capitals in your caption and say it out loud in the video.

Business	Keyword	What they get
Sneaker cleaning	CLEAN	Price list and booking link
Tutoring	PLAN	A free one-week study plan for [subject]
Resume reviews	RESUME	A 5-point resume checklist
Video editing for gyms	CLIPS	Three sample edits and your rates
Lawn care	QUOTE	A quick quote form for your street
Print-on-demand	DROP	Early access link to the next drop

- Skip words people type anyway, like YES, LOVE or WOW. You'll DM people who never asked.
- Use one keyword per post, so you know which post brought each lead.
- Only offer what you'll actually send. The free thing has to be worth the tap.

Set it up

1. In ManyChat, go to Automations, then New Automation. Pick the Auto-DM links from comments template, or start from scratch with a Post or Reel Comment trigger.
2. Choose what it watches: a specific post or reel, any post or reel, or your next one. Start with one specific post.
3. Add your keyword, plus the plural or a common misspelling.
4. Turn on the public reply. Add two or three versions so they rotate (copy below). The same reply on every comment can look like spam.
5. Turn on the Opening DM. This is the message with one button (copy below).
6. Write the main message: the link plus one real question (copy below).
7. Optional: turn on the email request, only if you'll actually email them.
8. Optional: turn on one follow-up for people who didn't open the link. One reminder, not three.
9. Click Go Live. On the phone app, tap Preview And Go Live.
10. Add the call to action to your caption and say it in the video.

Want more versions of these messages? The Day One Stack has a Comment-to-DM flow prompt. Run it, then rewrite the drafts in your own voice.

Your messages

CAPTION CALL TO ACTION COPY

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Comment [KEYWORD] and I'll send you [free thing].
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PUBLIC REPLIES (ADD ALL THREE SO THEY ROTATE) COPY

1. Sent. Check your DMs.
2. Just messaged you the [free thing].
3. It's in your inbox. Tell me what you think.

OPENING DM (ONE BUTTON) COPY

Hey, thanks for commenting on my [topic] post. Tap below and I'll send the [free thing] right now.

Button: Send it

MAIN MESSAGE (AFTER THEY TAP) COPY

Here you go: [link]

Quick question so I can actually help: [one question about their situation, e.g. what shoes are you trying to clean?]

Reply here. I read every message myself.

OPTIONAL EMAIL REQUEST COPY

Want this by email too? Drop your email here. I only send [what you'll send, e.g. one cleaning tip a week], and you can opt out anytime.

OPTIONAL FOLLOW-UP (SEND WITHIN 24 HOURS OF THEIR TAP) COPY

Hey, making sure the [free thing] came through: [link]. Questions? Reply here and I'll answer you myself.

Hand off to you

The automation stops at the link. Everything after that is you. Reply personally the same day.

1. Check your ManyChat Inbox or Instagram DMs twice a day.
2. Answer every real question yourself: prices for custom jobs, timing, complaints, special requests.
3. Use the reply below when someone needs more than the link.

HANDOFF REPLY (YOU SEND THIS YOURSELF) COPY

Hey [name], good question. [Real answer in one or two lines.] Want me to [next step: hold a spot / send a quote / book a quick call]?

Log every lead

Everyone who taps the button is a lead. Add them to your Pipeline Tracker the same day, with a next step and a date.

Date	Handle	Post or keyword	What they asked	Next step	Next step date
[date]	@[handle]	CLEAN reel	Price for suede?	Send quote	[date]

Meta's rules

- One automated message per comment, sent within 7 days of the comment. More only after the person responds.
- Automated replies only go out within 24 hours of their last message or tap. After that, wait for them to message you.
- Only DM people who asked. No mass DMs, no bought lists, no follow-for-follow tricks.
- Send exactly what the caption promised. No bait-and-switch.
- If someone says stop, stop.

Test it

- [ ] A friend comments your keyword on the post. Test from their account, not yours.
- [ ] The public reply shows under their comment.
- [ ] The Opening DM arrives with the button.
- [ ] They tap the button and the link arrives and opens on their phone.
- [ ] They reply with a question and you see it in your inbox.
- [ ] A comment without the keyword gets nothing.
- [ ] You log the test lead in your Pipeline Tracker, then delete it.

Keep it human

> Automate the repeat, never the relationship. ManyChat sends the link. You answer questions, quote custom work, follow up with anyone interested and read every reply yourself.

If it breaks

- No DM arrives: check the automation is live and watching the right post. In Instagram's message settings, check that connected tools can access your messages. Then reconnect Instagram in ManyChat.
- It worked, then stopped: you may have hit the free plan's monthly contact limit. Check your plan in ManyChat.
- The wrong people get DMs: your keyword is too common. Pick one nobody types by accident.
- The link won't open: test it in a private browser window and fix the sharing settings.

- People get the button but never the link: they didn't tap. That's normal. Don't chase them past the one follow-up.

Next step

The DMs will bring the same five questions every day. Set up Saved Replies next, so you answer each one in one tap and keep the conversation personal.

Make today day one.

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